

LeadFast AI

An AI-powered instant lead response system for US home service contractors — built to capture and respond to incoming leads within 30 seconds, every time.

DOCUMENT TYPE	Full build & launch plan
VERSION	1.0
TARGET MARKET	United States — home services
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CONTENTS

Table of contents

A complete reference covering the product concept, technical architecture, pricing, go-to-market plan, and known risks.

1	Executive summary The problem, the solution, and why it works	03
2	System architecture How a lead becomes a sent reply in 30 seconds	04
3	Technology stack Tools, costs, and what each one does	05
4	Database schema Supabase tables and structure	06
5	AI prompt design How the auto-reply is generated	07
6	Pricing & packaging Three tiers, and the math to \$1K MRR	08
7	Go-to-market plan 12-week build and launch timeline	09
8	Risks & mitigations What could go wrong, and the fix	11

SECTION 1

Executive summary

The problem

US home service contractors — HVAC technicians, plumbers, roofers — routinely lose paying jobs because they fail to respond to website contact form submissions within the first five minutes. Contractors are typically in the field, hands occupied, and unable to check email or a CRM dashboard in real time. American consumers expect a fast response; without one, they move to the next contractor on their search results page.

CORE INSIGHT

This is not a feature gap — it is a response-time gap. The contractor doesn't need a better CRM, they need their very first reply sent automatically, in seconds, before the lead has a chance to call someone else.

The solution

LeadFast AI is a lightweight script installed on a contractor's website. When a lead submits the contact form, the system captures the request, generates a personalized, context-aware reply using a fast AI model, and sends it automatically — typically within 15 to 30 seconds. The lead receives a response that references their specific problem and the business by name, while the contractor is simultaneously notified and the lead is logged to a simple dashboard.

Why this is workable from Kenya

- The entire pipeline is API-driven — no physical presence, no US office, no in-person sales required.
- Time zone difference (Kenya is UTC+3) means support and monitoring can run during Kenyan daytime while covering most US business hours via automation.
- The problem is well-documented and painful — contractors already lose real, quantifiable revenue to slow response times.
- Distribution does not rely on cold scraped email; it relies on a personalized demonstration, which converts on credibility rather than on being a known local vendor.

Key numbers at a glance

~\$10

Total setup cost

5 weeks

Time to working MVP

\$0.01

Cost per lead processed

20 usersCustomers needed for
\$1K MRR

SECTION 2

System architecture

The pipeline is intentionally simple — five steps, no unnecessary middleware. The original concept proposed routing everything through n8n on a separate server; this version removes that layer in favor of a single serverless API route, reducing both cost and points of failure.

The pipeline

1 Lead submits the contact form

A small embed script on the contractor's website intercepts the form submission before or alongside the normal handler.

2 Next.js API route receives the payload

A serverless function on Vercel accepts the lead data directly — name, contact info, problem description, business ID.

3 Claude Haiku drafts a reply

The API route calls the Claude Haiku model with a structured prompt containing the lead's message and the business's name and trade.

4 Resend sends the email

The generated reply is sent to the lead's inbox. A copy or summary is optionally sent to the contractor via email or SMS.

5 Supabase logs the interaction

The lead, the generated response, and delivery status are stored for the contractor's dashboard view.

DESIGN DECISION

n8n is deliberately excluded from the MVP. A direct API route does the same job with one fewer service to pay for, monitor, and debug. Add a workflow tool later only if non-technical customization becomes a real requirement.

Target response time

The full pipeline — from form submission to email delivered — should complete in under 30 seconds. Each stage is fast: the API route responds in roughly 200 milliseconds, the Claude Haiku call completes in two to four seconds, and Resend delivers near-instantly. The dominant cost is network latency, not processing.

SECTION 3

Technology stack

Every tool below has a free or near-free tier sufficient for an MVP and early growth. None require a US entity or address to sign up.

Layer	Tool	Cost	Purpose
Frontend + API	Next.js on Vercel	Free tier	Hosts the dashboard and the API route that receives leads
Database	Supabase (PostgreSQL)	Free tier	Stores businesses, leads, AI responses, and settings
Authentication	Supabase Auth	Free tier	Contractor login via magic link or Google OAuth
AI generation	Claude Haiku API	~\$0.01/lead	Drafts the personalized reply email
Email delivery	Resend	3,000 free/mo	Sends the AI-generated reply to the lead
SMS alerts (optional)	Twilio	Pay as you go	Texts the contractor when a new lead arrives
Embed script	Vanilla JavaScript	Free	Single script tag pasted into the contractor's site
Payments	Lemon Squeezy	5% per sale	Subscription billing, handles US sales tax automatically
Domain	Namecheap	~\$10/yr	A .com domain for the product

COMPATIBILITY NOTE

Many contractor websites are built on Wix, Squarespace, or GoDaddy's builder, which limit custom script access. Test the embed snippet on each of these platforms before promising broad compatibility to a customer.

SECTION 4

Database schema

Four core tables in Supabase. Row-level security policies should scope every table to `business_id` so contractors only ever see their own data.

businesses

```
-- One row per contractor account
id          uuid primary key default gen_random_uuid()
owner_id    uuid references auth.users(id)
business_name text not null
trade       text -- 'hvac', 'plumbing', 'roofing'
contact_email text not null
contact_phone text
plan        text default 'starter' -- 'starter', 'pro', 'multi_location'
created_at  timestampz default now()
```

leads

```
-- One row per incoming lead, captured from the embed script
id          uuid primary key default gen_random_uuid()
business_id uuid references businesses(id)
lead_name    text
lead_email   text
lead_phone   text
message      text -- the raw form submission text
status       text default 'received' -- 'received', 'replied', 'failed'
created_at   timestampz default now()
```

ai_responses

```
-- The generated reply tied to a lead
id          uuid primary key default gen_random_uuid()
lead_id     uuid references leads(id)
generated_text text not null
model_used  text default 'claude-haiku'
sent_at     timestampz
delivery_status text -- 'sent', 'bounced', 'pending'
```

```
-- Per-business customization
business_id  uuid references businesses(id) primary key
reply_tone   text default 'friendly_professional'
sms_alerts_enabled boolean default false
custom_signature text
```

SECURITY NOTE

Enable row-level security on every table with a policy of the form `business_id = auth.uid()` (resolved via the `businesses` table) so one contractor can never query another's leads.

SECTION 5

AI prompt design

The quality of the generated email is the single most important technical factor in this product. A generic or robotic-sounding reply damages the contractor's reputation with their own lead. The prompt below is a starting template — test it against real form submissions before relying on it for paying customers.

Prompt template structure

System: You are writing a fast, friendly email reply on behalf of {business_name}, a {trade} company. The lead just submitted a contact form. Reply within 2-3 short paragraphs. Reference their specific problem. Sound like a real person at the business wrote it, not a corporate bot. Include a clear next step (call, schedule, or confirm they'll hear back today). Sign off as the {business_name} team.

User: Lead message: "{lead_message}"
Lead name: {lead_name}

Variables to fill per request

Variable	Source
business_name	From the businesses table
trade	From the businesses table — HVAC, plumbing, roofing
lead_message	The raw text submitted in the contact form
lead_name	From the form, if collected

Quality checks before going live

- ✓ Test with at least 15 realistic, varied lead messages per trade before charging any customer
- ✓ Manually review every AI-generated reply during the first two weeks of any new customer's usage
- ✓ Add a fallback template if the AI call fails or times out — never let a lead go unanswered due to an API error
- ✓ Keep the tone configurable per business — some contractors want more casual, others more formal

SECTION 6

Pricing & packaging

STARTER \$25/mo Up to 50 leads/month AI auto-reply email Basic lead dashboard No SMS alerts	PRO — MOST POPULAR \$49/mo Up to 300 leads/month SMS alert to owner Custom reply tone & branding Response analytics	MULTI-LOCATION \$99/mo Unlimited leads Multiple locations/inboxes CRM export (CSV/Zapier) Priority support
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Path to \$1,000 monthly recurring revenue

Scenario	Customers needed	Plan
All Starter	40 customers	\$25/mo
All Pro (recommended target)	20 customers	\$49/mo
All Multi-location	11 customers	\$99/mo
Realistic blend	~25 customers	Mostly Pro, a few Starter

MARGIN NOTE

At roughly \$0.01 cost per lead processed, even a Starter customer sending 50 leads a month costs about \$0.50 in AI fees against \$25 in revenue. Margins are very healthy — the binding constraint on growth is customer acquisition, not infrastructure cost.

SECTION 7

Go-to-market plan

A 12-week sequence from validation to a working \$1,000 MRR target. Each phase has a clear exit condition before moving to the next.

Weeks 1 — Validate and pick a sub-niche

- Choose one trade to start with — HVAC, plumbing, or roofing — not all three at once. A narrow focus builds sharper messaging and faster trust.
- Manually identify 30 real contractor websites in that trade with slow or missing auto-reply systems. Avoid scraped bulk lists.
- Submit test inquiries through 5 of their own contact forms and time how long they actually take to respond.

Weeks 2 — 5 — Build the MVP

- Set up the Supabase schema (see Section 4).
- Build the embed script that intercepts the form submission and posts to the API route.
- Wire the API route to call Claude Haiku using the prompt template (see Section 5).
- Connect Resend for email delivery and build the minimal lead dashboard.

Week 6 — Build the sales asset

Record a personalized before/after video for each target business: their current contact form's slow or absent response, followed by the same form replying in fifteen seconds with LeadFast AI. This single asset is more persuasive than any written pitch, because it demonstrates the exact problem on the exact business being approached.

SECTION 7 (CONTINUED)

Go-to-market plan

Weeks 7 — 9 — Outreach without scraping

- Send the personalized demo video to roughly 30 contractors, using contact details published on their own website rather than purchased or scraped lists.
- Post in relevant trade communities — for example r/HVAC, r/Plumbing, r/Construction — offering a free trial in exchange for honest feedback.
- Join 3 to 5 local Facebook groups for contractors in mid-size US cities and offer the same free trial.
- Target outcome: 10 contractors actively using a free trial by the end of week 9.

Weeks 10 — 12 — Convert and expand

- After a 14-day free trial, convert users to paid with a founding-member offer — for example, locking in the Starter price permanently.
- Ask satisfied customers for a one-line testimonial and a referral to another contractor they know in the trade.
- Once the first trade is generating consistent signups, replicate the exact playbook in a second trade.
- Target outcome: roughly 20 paying customers, averaging close to \$49 per month, reaching approximately \$1,000 in monthly recurring revenue.

Channel priorities, in order

1. Personalized demo videos sent directly to researched contractors
2. Organic posts in trade-specific Reddit communities and Facebook groups
3. Referrals from early paying customers
4. Listing on a marketplace such as AppSumo once the product is stable, for broader reach

SECTION 8

Risks & mitigations

Cold outreach compliance

Scraped, bulk email lists carry real CAN-SPAM exposure and will burn a sending domain's reputation quickly. **Mitigation:** rely on low-volume, manually researched, personalized outreach. It is slower but converts at a meaningfully higher rate and carries far less risk.

Trust gap as an unfamiliar vendor

Contractors are naturally cautious about unfamiliar software vendors, more so one based outside the US. **Mitigation:** lead every pitch with a working demo built on the contractor's own website. A demonstration outperforms a sales pitch and reduces the need for borrowed credibility.

AI reply quality

A poorly written or generic AI reply can actively damage a contractor's relationship with a real lead. **Mitigation:** test extensively against real-world form submissions before any customer is charged, and manually review replies during a new customer's first weeks.

Embed compatibility

Many small contractor websites run on Wix, Squarespace, or similar builders with limited script access. **Mitigation:** test the embed snippet against the most common platforms before promising universal compatibility.

Reachability of small businesses

Many trade businesses check email infrequently. **Mitigation:** test outreach through the contractor's own contact form, and where possible, a short follow-up text message, rather than relying on email alone.

CLOSING NOTE

None of these risks are disqualifying. Each has a known, practical mitigation that fits within the minimal-budget, fully-remote constraints of this build. The core economics — extremely low cost per lead against a real, demonstrable problem — remain favorable throughout.